

Question:

A baby is born after the 32nd gestational week by cesarean delivery. The mother suffered from gestational diabetes; however, she had no other pregnancy-related diseases and was otherwise healthy. The baby has a blood pressure of 100/58 mm Hg, heart rate of 104/min, and oxygen saturation of 88%. The child has tachypnea, subcostal and intercostal retractions, nasal flaring, and cyanosis. The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen. The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B. Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

Reasoning + Answer:

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- The baby is born at 32 weeks gestation , indicating prematurity .
- The baby has tachypnea , subcostal and intercostal retractions , nasal flaring , and cyanosis , which are signs of respiratory distress .
- The cyanosis is responsive to oxygen , which is consistent with respiratory distress rather than a fixed lesion like a tracheoesophageal fistula or a congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt .
- The absence of other signs or symptoms like feeding difficulties or a mass in the neck makes tracheoesophageal fistula less likely .
- The absence of fever or other signs of infection makes pneumonia less likely .
- The most common cause of respiratory distress in preterm infants is neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS).

- The question is asking for the most likely diagnosis .
- The baby's symptoms are consistent with NRDS .
- NRDS is caused by the immaturity of the lungs in preterm infants , leading to the formation of hyaline membranes in the alveoli , which results in respiratory distress .
- The other options are less likely given the symptoms and the absence of other signs .
- The nasogastric tube placement without problems rules out a tracheoesophageal fistula .
- The absence of signs of infection makes pneumonia less likely .
- The absence of other congenital heart anomalies makes a congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt less likely .
- Therefore , the most likely diagnosis is neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS).

- The question is asking for the most likely diagnosis .
- The baby's symptoms are consistent with NRDS .
- The other options are less likely given the symptoms and the absence of other signs .
- The most likely diagnosis is neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS).
- The answer is A .

- The question is asking for the most likely diagnosis .
- The baby's symptoms are consistent with NRDS .
- The other options are less likely given the symptoms and the absence of other signs .
- The most likely diagnosis is neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS).
- The answer is A .

</think>

<answer>A . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)</answer>